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The anatomy of the deal in a Sox season full of swings

Plenty of elements needed to fall into place in order to nab All-Star Rutschman

By Alex Speier
GLOBE STAFF

Inside the makeshift trade deadline headquarters above Brookline Avenue to which dozens of Red Sox front office members had relocated, a question confronted Craig Breslow in the early afternoon of Aug. 3.

With the Sox amid an unprecedented midsummer surge, the front office was determined to reinforce a group that had forgotten how to lose. Several hours before the 6 p.m. trade deadline, Breslow had a clear opportunity to do just that.

He and Baltimore Orioles general manager Mike Elias — Breslow's teammate at Yale — had defined the contours of a deal to bring three-time All-Star Adley Rutschman to the Sox. But acquiring the catcher would come at considerable cost.

Any analytically driven model would characterize a deal sending three top prospects and catcher Carlos Narv  ez to Baltimore as lopsidedly tilted toward the Orioles. Breslow understood this. He considered whether there was a deal to be made with another team, either at a lesser prospect cost or for a player with more years of future control.

But if the Sox waited, they might lose Rutschman to a rival — the Yankees, for instance, sought catchers — with no guarantee of landing another difference-maker. Breslow distilled his dilemma.

“How many good trades do you pass up in search of the perfect trade, only to find out that the perfect trade was never actually available?” he wondered.

Breslow and the Sox took the bird in hand — in this case, an Oriole. Rutschman represented a

RED SOX DEAL, Page C5



JONATHAN WIGGS/GLOBE STAFF

The Red Sox seized the opportunity to acquire catcher Adley Rutschman.

Some signatures on Rollins's nomination papers questioned

Four officials deny adding names for DA candidate

By Kelly Garrity and Sean Cotter
GLOBE STAFF

In a matter of weeks this spring, former US attorney Rachael Rollins gathered more than 1,600 signatures to secure her place on the September primary ballot and officially mount her comeback bid for the Suffolk district attorney's office she once led.

But at least four elected officials in Chelsea whom Rollins had listed as signing their names told The Boston Globe that they, in fact, never did. Two others whose name appeared twice on Rollins's nomination papers said they did offer their signatures, but only once, raising questions about how their names appeared again.

“Even if this was an innocent mistake, people need to know that it's not OK,” said Lisa Anne Santagate, a Chelsea city councilor whose name appeared on Rollins's papers. She said she's been inquiring at City Hall and calling her colleagues to see how this could have happened.

“That's not my signature,” she said. “Who's submitting my name?”

A spokesperson for Rollins's campaign did not

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PHOTOS BY IAN THOMAS JANSEN-LONNQUIST FOR THE BOSTON GLOBE

John Ovitt, plant manager of Franklin Foods, plans to take over the facility after it closes. At top, dairy equipment supplier Lely Center New England has a very common lawn ornament in Vermont: a cow statue.

A uniquely Vt. agony, as dairy sites close

Future of legendary sector unclear as plants consolidate elsewhere

By Paul Heintz
GLOBE STAFF

ENOSBURGH, Vt. — By mid-July, employees on the production floor of Franklin Foods were working on borrowed time. They were still packaging cream cheese for Panera Bread restaurants but were using equipment that had largely been auctioned off and that, in the coming weeks, would be shipped out as well — and with it, most of their jobs.

The company's German owner, Hochland Group, announced earlier this summer it would close the plant, which for 127 years has turned milk from nearby farms into a variety of dairy products and employed close to 100 people.

“If you talk to anybody in town, either they've worked here, or their brother worked here, or their father worked here,” said plant manager John Ovitt, who has spent more than 37 years at the facility. “It's kind of woven into the fabric of Enosburgh.”

A spate of similar plant closures this summer has stunned those whose livelihoods depend on Vermont's signature dairy industry, not least because it comes as protein is enjoying such a moment among con-

“The challenge in Vermont is not just how do we maintain our dairy industry, but how do we grow it?”

TOM BELLAVANCE,
Vermont dairy farmer

sumers that producers in other states are racing to build facilities and boost output. The damage has been concentrated in Franklin County, a verdant stretch of the Champlain Valley near the Canadian border. The county is long known as Vermont's dairy capital.

Perrigo, the multinational pharmaceutical company, laid off 162 workers in June at its infant formula plant in the town of Georgia, part of a phased shutdown that's expected to claim about 420 Vermont jobs by next year. The national cooperative Dairy Farmers of America is preparing to idle its St. Albans plant this month, eliminating 80 jobs. Elsewhere in the state, HP Hood closed its Booth Bros. Dairy plant in Barre this spring, laying off 70 people.

“We haven't experienced anything like this in decades,” said Tim Smith, executive director of the Franklin County Industrial Development Corporation.

Vermont dairy farms have been closing

DAIRY, Page A10

Let's take a 90-degree turn and talk winter

Historic El Ni  o is here. It may alter our storm patterns.

By Ken Mahan
GLOBE STAFF

Yes, it's been as hot as it gets around here. Boston just registered its second heat wave of the season. But for us weather types, August means we start to think about what comes next, heat not withstanding.

For me, that means events like hurricanes, potent coastal storms, and other severe occasions that come with the change of seasons.

Every once in a while, an outlier comes along. And sometimes the outlier can be something we haven't seen before, such as an intense weather pattern that can reshape an entire season.

This year's Super El Ni  o is it, and we're about to see its strongest influence yet during late fall and all winter.

What does this mean? First, here in New England, we're likely not going to experience a cold and very snowy winter as we experienced this past season. But even in a warmer season, the storms will keep coming (more on that later).

The entire globe is entering uncharted territory with this rare, burgeoning El Ni  o, because it's not just a strong phenomenon. It has a legitimate chance of becoming the strongest we've seen, in over a century.

This El Ni  o reached “super” status this summer, occurring when ocean temperatures in the Equatorial Pacific Ocean, off the coast of South America, heated up at least 2 degrees Celsius above normal. The last time we broke that threshold was in 2015-2016.

This particular event, however, is set to surpass that one and even eclipse the strongest El Ni  o on record, back in 1877-1878, when sea-surface temperatures reached a

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My sol to keep

Tuesday: Mix of sun, clouds.
High 87-92, low 68-73.

Wednesday: Same but cooler.
High 81-86, low 66-71.

Weather and comics, **D5-6**.
Obituaries, **C9**.

Colombians frantically searched the rubble of collapsed buildings after a powerful earthquake devastated parts of the nation near the Pacific Ocean. A4.

A psychiatrist for Lindsay Clancy faced withering cross-ex-

amination in the murder trial of the Duxbury mother. B1.

Electricity suppliers have charged New England consumers billions of dollars in excess costs over the past decade, according to a report from a Cambridge think tank. D1.

The Trump administration proposed requiring food companies to alert the government when they are adding new ingredients to products. A2.

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